

Lone Rangers

Increase in the number of suicides in paramilitary forces reflects the working conditions of the jawans. ("Depressed Triggers", June 25). Their job specifications must be relaxed and more recruitment should be made to ease the pressure on these people.

MANSI ANEJA, Delhi

Wrong Calculation

It's incorrect to say that saving Rs 500 per month by not joining a gym and Rs 96 per month by not buying mineral water can fetch one Rs 6.15 lakh and Rs 1.18 lakh at the end of 25 years, if invested at 10 per cent a year ("Best of the Month", June 25). At 10 per cent interest rate, a sum will double in about six-and-a-half years. In such a case, investments of Rs 96 per month and Rs 500 per month stand at Rs 10,000 and Rs 48,000, respectively, at the end of 25 years.

ASOKE C. BANERJEE, Kolkata

Modern Bihar

I hope Nitish Kumar takes Bihar to the modern age ("Fasten Seat Belts", June 25). However, this is just the beginning. He is yet to pass the test of being a successful chief minister.

APARNA SEN, Patna

Magic of Modi

Despite all the criticism Narendra Modi is subjected to, there is no denying that he's one of the best administrators in the country ("Setting New Records", June 25). It will be really tough for the Opposition to dethrone him.

MANISHA LAMBA, Ahmedabad

The fact that a mass-murderer is their brand ambassador, speaks volumes for the Hindutva brigade. Modi is the biggest of all criminals in Indian politics and he should be dethroned in the next election.

INDRAJIT DAS, Delhi

Food for Thought

Global warming will have a negative impact on the farm sector ("Grain Drain", June 11). There is no magic bullet that can solve the problems of agri-

culture. The Government should take steps to manage the country's water resources. Also, it should ensure enough research happens in agricultural universities.

S. M. SEHGAL FOUNDATION,
Des Moines, USA

Correction

We erroneously carried the picture of last year's G-8 summit in our story "The Great Bureaubabble" (June 25). The mistake is regretted.



The bureaucracy has been growing in the name of accommodating few unwanted ministers ("White Elephants", June 18). It is possible to reduce the number of existing ministries only if efforts are made to introduce transparency, accountability.

MOHAN DHARIA, Pune

Your issue has highlighted the colossal waste of the exchequer's money by a large army of ministers of the UP Government. The excuse of coalition compulsions is not tenable. When countries like the US and France can make do with small cabinets, why can't we?

SHYAMA ANAND, on e-mail

The disclosures in the cover story throws light on corruption prevailing in the Cabinet. Every politician, particularly every minister without any work, should hang his head in shame.

V.S. VENKATAVARADAN, on e-mail

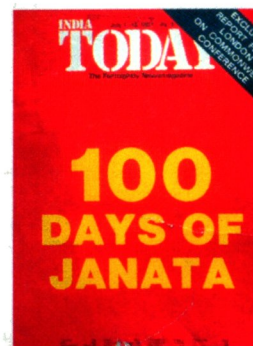
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Years Ago in India Today

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The Gold Crush

People in the Bombay-based film industry are so used to their cops-and-robbers plots that when a real crisis ambushes them they can never see things in proper perspective. The latest flap is the budget bombshell—the straight 10 per cent ad valorem excise slapped on to films proportionate to their production costs.

Almost nine Desai blockbusters, all costing Rs 40 lakh and above, have been stopped. The cost of film production could be calculated by taking into account the total "coverage" with less 10 per cent of the expected profit. For example if a picture covers Rs 50 lakh, then Rs 45 lakh will be taken as the levy charged by the government. But within 90 days the producer will have to produce a proper cost of production. For an industry that is notorious for its mismanagement, this is an impossible task. So the ultimate result is stalemate.

—Ashok Row Kavi

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